

UNIT
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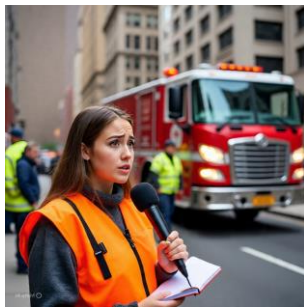
BREAKING NEWS

CONVERSATION

Anchor (Emily): Good evening. We begin tonight with breaking news. Officials have confirmed a fire in the downtown area.

Co-Anchor (Michael): That's right, Emily. The fire department says the blaze broke out just moments ago, but crews managed to get it under control quickly.

Anchor (Emily): Images and footage have been captured by several eyewitnesses. We have live team coverage for you tonight. Our reporter Sarah is on the scene with the very latest. Sarah?



Reporter (Sarah): Thanks, Emily. We're standing just blocks away from where the fire broke out. Behind me, you can still see emergency vehicles surrounding the building. Although the flames were put out earlier, heavy smoke continues to pour into the air. Eyewitness accounts have been collected by the authorities, and an official explanation is expected later tonight.

Co-Anchor (Michael): Sarah, do we know yet if anyone was hurt?

Reporter (Sarah): Good news there, Michael—no injuries have been reported. Residents were evacuated quickly, and assistance was provided by emergency teams. We've also learned that the first 911 call came from a shop owner in the area.

Anchor (Emily): Alright, Sarah, thank you for that update. We'll keep monitoring this story throughout the evening and bring you any new details as they come in. Stay with us—there's much more news ahead.

VOCABULARY



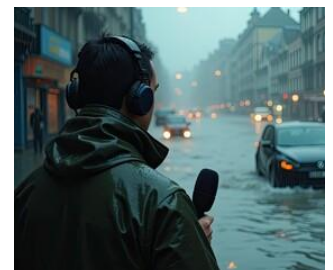
Headline



Footage



Anchor



Live coverage



Reporter



Search



Eyewitness



Statement

LANGUAGE PRACTICE

Passive voice



UNIT
66

BREAKING NEWS

EXERCISE 1

Complete the sentences using past passive. Fill in the correct form of *be* + past participle (verb in parentheses).

1. The headline _____ *was chosen* _____ (choose) yesterday.
2. The story _____ (write) by the reporter last night.
3. The news _____ (present) live at 8 p.m.
4. The event _____ (describe) by several eyewitnesses.
5. The footage _____ (review) after the fire.

EXERCISE 2

Complete the sentences using *has/have + been + past participle*.

- A. The headline _____ *has been chosen* _____ (choose) for tonight's broadcast.
- B. The footage _____ (review) already.
- C. The live coverage _____ (broadcast) during the day.
- D. Statements _____ (release) by the authorities so far. The population demands answers.
- E. The search _____ (launch) in several areas.

SUMMARY

Tense	Structure	Examples with Vocabulary	Use / Notes
Simple Past Passive	Subject + was/were + past participle	The headline was chosen for tonight's broadcast. The footage was reviewed before being aired. The statement was released by the authorities after the incident.	Action happened in the past at a specific time; doer unknown or unimportant.
Present Perfect Passive	Subject + has/have + been + past participle	The live coverage has been broadcast to millions of viewers. The search has been launched in the surrounding area. The footage has been collected for investigation.	Action happened at unspecified past time. doer unknown or unimportant.

EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

Exercise 1

- A. was chosen
- B. was written
- C. was presented
- D. was described
- E. was reviewed

Exercise 2

- A. has been chosen
- B. has been reviewed
- C. has been broadcast
- D. haven't been released
- E. has been launched